



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

gautamasyāśramam puṇyam samṛddham cānnavāriṇā | BRP085.003.1
ātmānam ca kṣudhāyuktaṁ samṛddham cāpi gautamam || 3 || BRP085.003.2
vīkṣya kaṇvo 'tha vaiṣamyam vairāgyam agamat tadā | BRP085.004.1
gautamo 'pi dvijaśreṣṭho hy aham tapasi niṣṭhitaḥ || 4 || BRP085.004.2

— Brahmapurāṇa, Chapter 85: Story of Kaṇva's hunger (Chapter 85), Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

The hermitage of Gautama, described as 'punya' (meritorious) and 'samrddha' (prosperous) with food and water, represents the abundance that life, and indeed the divine, offers. Yet, within this very sanctuary, Kaṇva experiences intense hunger, highlighting a critical dichotomy. This isn't simply a tale of physical hunger; it's a metaphor for the spiritual yearning that can exist even amidst material comfort and apparent blessings.

Kaṇva's realization of this 'vaishamya' (disparity) – the stark difference between the external abundance and his internal emptiness – triggers 'vairagya,' a state of detachment. This detachment isn't a rejection of the good things in life, but rather a turning inward, a recognition that true fulfillment cannot be found solely in external provisions. Gautama himself, a respected Brahmin deeply immersed in asceticism, further emphasizes this point. He is absorbed in his tapas, his spiritual practice, perhaps unaware of the deeper needs around him.

For you navigating the complexities of modern life, this passage offers profound insight. You might be surrounded by material wealth, career success, and loving relationships, yet still feel a persistent sense of unease, a spiritual hunger that remains unfulfilled. This hunger isn't necessarily a sign of something lacking in your life, but rather an invitation to look beyond the material and cultivate your inner landscape. Just as Kaṇva's hunger led him to detachment, your own sense of emptiness can be a catalyst for spiritual growth. It's a call to examine your values, your priorities, and to seek nourishment that transcends the physical realm, focusing on inner peace and divine connection. The abundance around you is a gift, but true fulfillment lies in recognizing and addressing the hunger within.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

Are you mistaking material comfort for spiritual fulfillment, and if so, what small step can you take today to nourish your inner self?